

Use of Portable Indoor Space Heaters

Definitions

Space heater: A space heater is a self-contained device for heating an enclosed area. Portable electric space heaters are regulated by Section 605.10 of the California Fire Code.

Space Heater Required Specifications

Only space heaters meeting the following criteria are permitted:

- The heater must be electrically powered and designated as approved with a nationally recognized testing laboratory mark [common marks include Underwriters Laboratories (UL) or FM Global Technologies (FM)]. Liquid-fuel (propane, kerosene) space heaters are not permitted.
- The space heater must have a thermostat for heat regulation. Heaters without thermostats (e.g., simple "on/off" or "high/low" switches) are not permitted.
- Space heaters must have a tip-over shutdown feature. If the heater is knocked over, the unit must automatically shut off.
- Space heaters that are not equipped with a tip-over shutdown feature must have overheat protection, which will automatically shut the unit off if there is an overheat situation.
- Space heaters listed in accordance with UL1278 comply with Section 605.10 of the California Fire Code.

Safe Use of Space Heaters

Location requirements

Approved space heaters must be used as follows:

- The heater may be placed only on the floor. Heaters located on filing cabinets, tables, desks or other surfaces are more susceptible to being knocked over, resulting in accidents or fires.
- Heaters may only be placed on electrical circuits sufficiently capable of handling the amperage draw of the heater and other equipment on the circuit.
- Heaters may not be used in areas where flammable liquids are in use or stored.
- Keep the heater away from water and out of damp locations.
- Maintain minimum clearance distances as specified by the manufacturer. Combustible or flammable materials must be kept away from the heater.

Operating requirements

- Inspect the heater and power cord for broken or damaged parts. Never operate a heater with obvious or suspected damage.
- Heaters must be plugged directly into a wall receptacle. Use of extension cords, power strips or other indirect means of providing power is not allowed.
- Electric cords must be kept out of foot traffic paths to prevent tripping.
- Do not run the heater's cord under doors, rugs, or carpeting. This can damage the cord and/or hide damage to the cord.
- The heater must be turned off any time the room or area being heated is unoccupied, especially at the end of the workday.